

The History of Ice Cream

Non-fiction

How ice cream began

Long ago, people in ancient China mixed milk and rice together and packed it in snow to make a cold pudding. People in ancient Rome also mixed snow with honey and fruit.

About 350 years ago, the King of England was given a recipe for a cold, creamy pudding. The recipe was so precious that the King paid the cook to keep it a secret. Today, ice cream is usually made from milk, cream and sugar.

Keeping ice cream cold

Before freezers were invented, people had to use blocks of ice to keep things cold. The ice was brought over from Norway, where there was plenty of it. This was a tricky task as the ice had to be transported before it melted.

Ice cream cones

About 100 years ago, at a big fair in the United States of America, an ice cream seller ran out of the bowls he used to serve ice cream. Luckily, another man at the fair was selling waffles. He rolled his waffles into the shape of a cone so that they could hold the ice cream. People loved it!

Exciting flavours

Ice cream is sold in ice cream parlours. You can buy many exciting flavours there – some unusual ones include lime, cheese and curry! However, chocolate and vanilla are still the most popular flavours.

Interesting ice cream facts

- The United States of America holds a national Ice Cream Day.
- In the past, people used to buy a 'penny lick' – a small amount of ice cream served in a glass cup.
- New Zealand is the country where people eat the most ice cream.
- Norway holds the record for the tallest ice cream cone, which was 3 metres tall!